

Online appendix

Article: "Between common responsibility and national interest: When do Europeans support a common European migration policy?" (by Philipp Lutz)

Contents

A. Data description	2
Table A1: Descriptive statistics of the variables (1992-2012)	2
Table A2: Descriptive statistics of the variables (2014-2021)	2
Figure A1: Histograms of the refugee exposure variables	2
Table A3: List of variables	4
B. Threshold calculation for exposure to the refugee crisis	5
Figure A2: Scatter plot of country clusters	5
C. Diagnostics and robustness checks	6
Figure A3: Component-plus-residual plots of panel regression models	6
Figure A4: Predicted probabilities of policy support by number of refugee arrivals	6
Table A4: Alternative panel model specifications	6
Figure A5: Support for an EU migration policy by country group	6
Figure A6: Pre-treatment trend of support for an EU migration policy	6
Figure A7: Country-specific trends in support for an EU migration policy	6
Table A5: DiD estimates with alternative model specifications	6
Figure A8: Predicted probabilities of support for EU migration policy	13

A. Data description

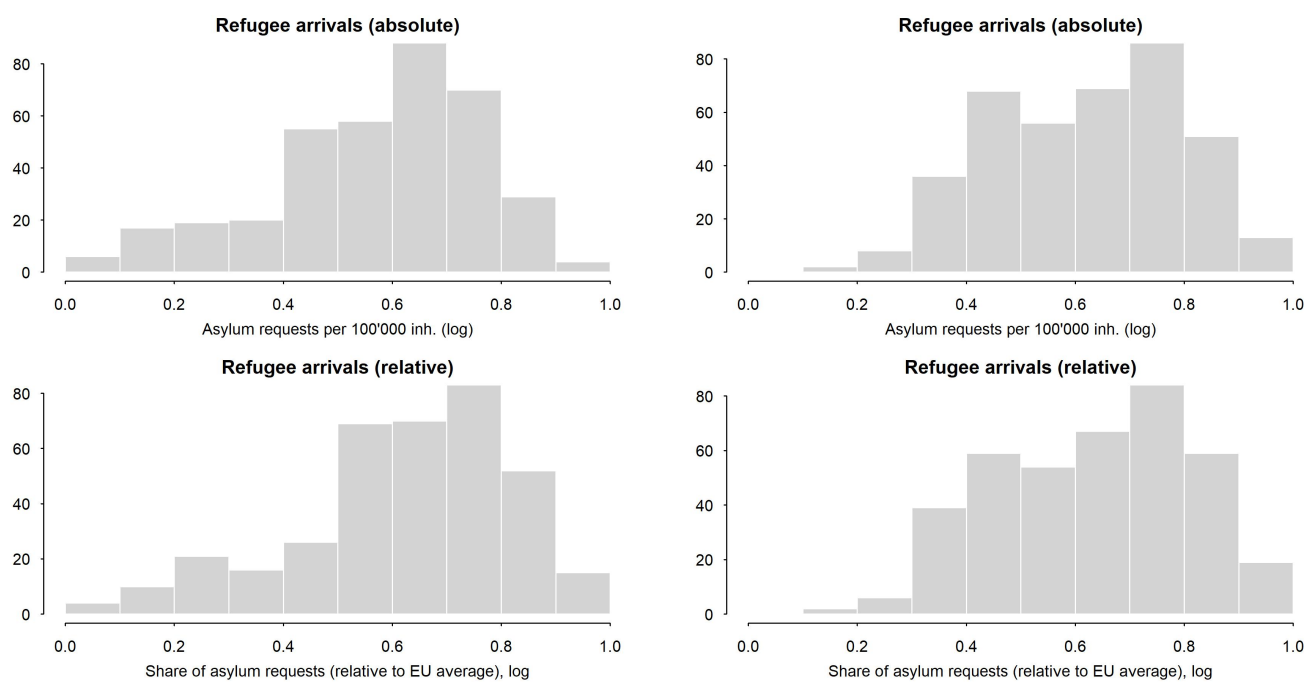
Table A1: Descriptive statistics of the variables (1992-2012)

Statistic	N	Mean	St. Dev.	Min	Max
Support EU migration policy	606	56.041	15.437	13.980	87.475
Refugee arrivals (absolute)	366	0.571	0.196	0.000	0.968
Refugee arrivals (relative)	366	0.623	0.200	0.000	1.000
EU attachment	69	2.444	0.226	1.959	3.015
Unemployment rate	606	8.255	3.923	1.810	24.210
Share of foreigners	394	0.078	0.086	0.001	0.435

Table A2: Descriptive statistics of variables (2014-2021)

Statistic	N	Mean	St. Dev.	Min	Max
Support EU migration policy	389	71.736	12.487	33.757	93.991
Refugee arrivals (absolute)	389	0.620	0.173	0.152	1.000
Refugee arrivals (relative)	389	0.632	0.178	0.173	0.983
EU attachment	333	2.562	0.221	1.949	3.097
Unemployment rate	389	7.675	4.185	2.010	26.490
Share of foreigners	389	0.089	0.089	0.003	0.478

Figure A1: Histograms of the refugee exposure variables



Note: Histograms showing the distribution of refugee arrivals across countries (log-transformed values scaled to a range from 0 to 1) for the first time series (1992-2012) on the left and the second time series (2014-2021) on the right.

Table A3: List of variables

Variable	Operationalisation	Data
Support for EU migration policy	For each of the following areas, do you think that decisions should be made by the (NATIONALITY) Government, or made jointly within the European Union? Response categories: 1 (National) government; 2 The European Union 33 waves between 1992 and 2011	Eurobarometer (37,39,40,41, 42,43.1,44.1,44.2bis,46.0,47.1, 48.0,49,50.0,51.0,52.0,53,54.1, 56.2,57.1,58.1,59.1,60.1,62.0, 64.2, 66.1, 67.2, 68.1, 69.2, 70.1,72.4, 73.4, 74.2, 76.3)
Immigration salience	What is your opinion on each of the following statements? Please tell me for each statement, whether you are for it or against it: A common European policy on migration (Response categories: For; Against) 13 waves between 2014 and 2021	Eurobarometer (82.3,83.1, 84.3,85.2,86.2,87.3,88.3,89.1, 90.3,91.5,92.3,93.1,94.3,95.3)
Control perceptions	”What do you think are the two most important issues facing (OUR COUNTRY) at the moment?”, ”And personally, what are the two most important issues you are facing at the moment?”, ”What do you think are the two most important issues facing the EU at the moment?” Based on these two items, I create a dummy variable of whether respondents consider immigration an important problem or not.	Eurobarometer (only country: 59.1,60.1,62.0,64.2,66.1,67.2, 68.1,69.2,70.1,72.4,73.4; both: 74.2,76.3,82.3,83.1,84.3,85.2, 86.2,87.3,88.3,89.1,90.3,91.5, 92.3,93.1,94.3,95.3)
EU attachment	”Please tell me how attached you feel to... [The European Union]” Response categories: Very attached (4); Fairly attached (3); Not very attached (2); Not at all attached (1)	Eurobarometer (82.3,83.1, 84.3,85.2,86.2,87.3,88.3,89.1, 90.3,91.5,92.3,93.1,94.3,95.3)
Left-right orientation	”In political matters people talk of ”the left” and ”the right”. How would you place your views on this scale?” Response scale from 1 (left) to 10 (right).	Eurobarometer (all waves except 76.3)
Refugee arrivals	Asylum claims submitted at the end of the year Absolute: Number of asylum claims per capita Relative: Absolute divided by the mean of all member states multiplied by 100	UNHCR
Share of foreigners	Share of non-citizens in the population (in %) [MIGR _{POP2CTZ}]	Eurostat
Unemployment rate	Official share of unemployed (in %)	ILO

B. Threshold calculation for exposure to the refugee crisis

For the difference-in-differences models the EU member states are classified into exposed and not-exposed countries based on whether they experienced a significant increase in asylum seekers during the 2015 refugee crisis. For that purpose, I follow Lutz and Karstens (2021) by comparing the number of asylum requests (ASYLUM) as a share of the population (POP) before and during the crisis. A two-fold measurement is used to account for the varying length of time in countries' registration of asylum-seekers with some registering the peak in 2015 and others only in 2016.

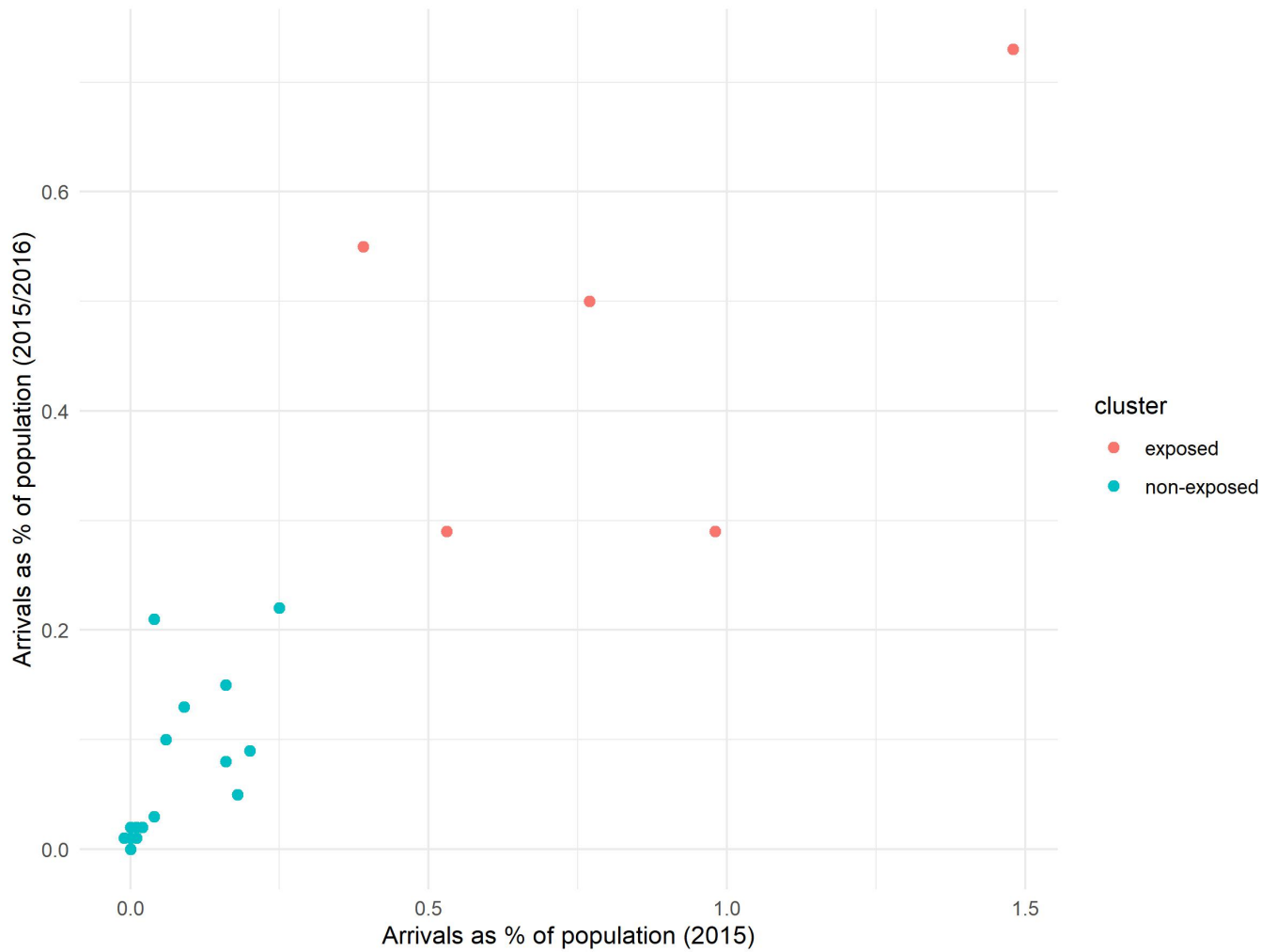
$$\text{Model 1} = \text{ASYLUM}_{2015} - \text{mean}(\text{ASYLUM}_{2013} + \text{ASYLUM}_{2014}) / \text{POP}_{2015} * 100$$

$$\text{Model 2} = \text{mean}(\text{ASYLUM}_{2015} + \text{ASYLUM}_{2016}) - \text{mean}(\text{ASYLUM}_{2013} + \text{ASYLUM}_{2014}) / \text{POP}_{2015} * 100$$

In the next step, I conduct a k-means cluster analysis that assigns countries into two clusters by minimising within-cluster variances. This results to five countries (Germany, Austria, Hungary, Sweden and Finland) being classified as exposed and the remaining 23 countries (Belgium, Bulgaria, Croatia, Cyprus, Czech Republic, Denmark, Estonia, France, Ireland, Greece, Italy, Latvia, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Malta, the Netherlands, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Slovenia, Slovakia, Spain, and the United Kingdom) as not-exposed. While the mean increase in the not-exposed countries is around 0.05% of the population, the mean increase in the exposed countries is around 10 times higher, around 0.5% of the population (see Figure A2 below).¹

¹The exact cluster means are 0.054/0.052 for the not exposed countries and 0.830/0.472 for the exposed countries.

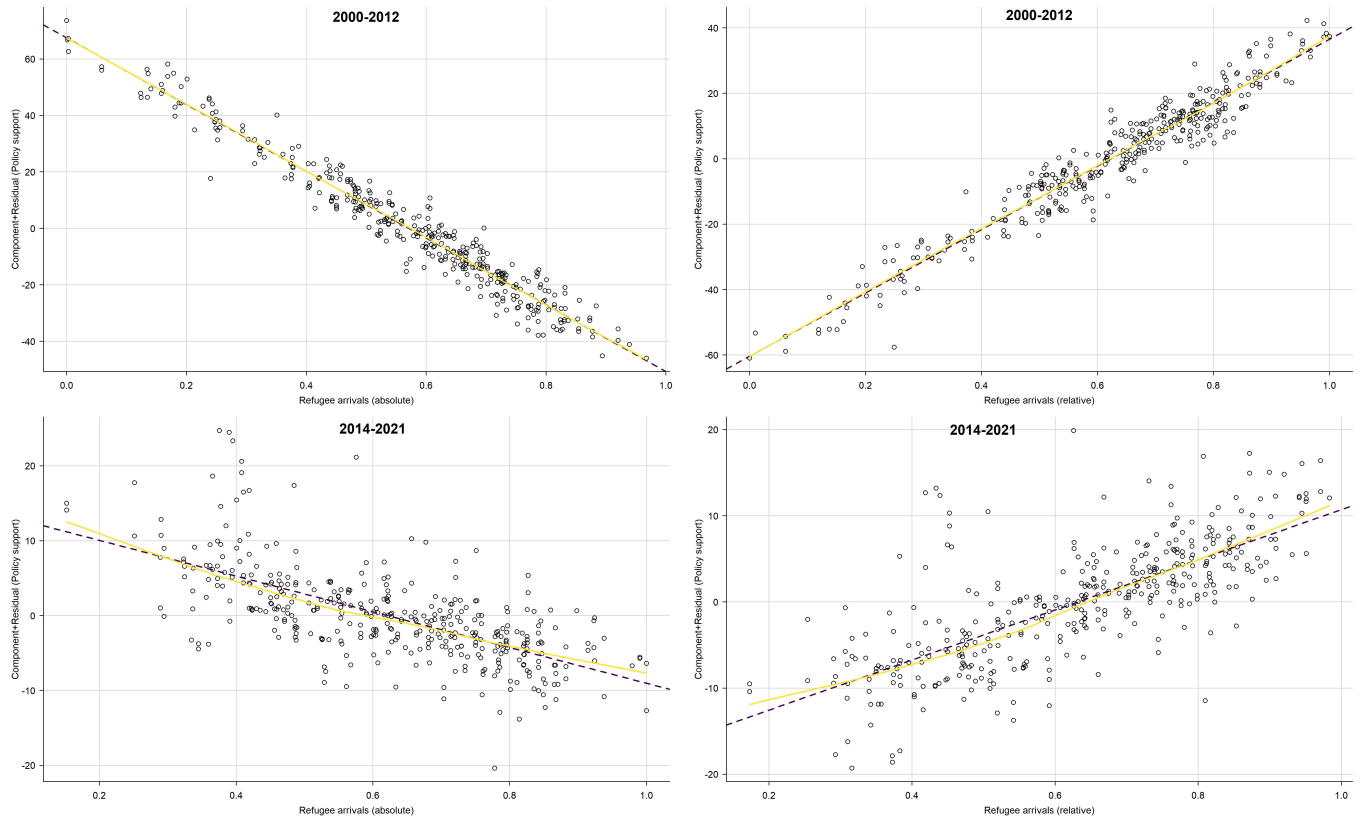
Figure A2: Scatter plot of country clusters



Note: The plot displays the results of a k-means cluster analysis. The x-axis displays countries' crisis exposure based on Model 1 only taking into account the year 2015. The y-axis displays countries' crisis exposure based on Model 2 taking into account the years 2015 and 2016.

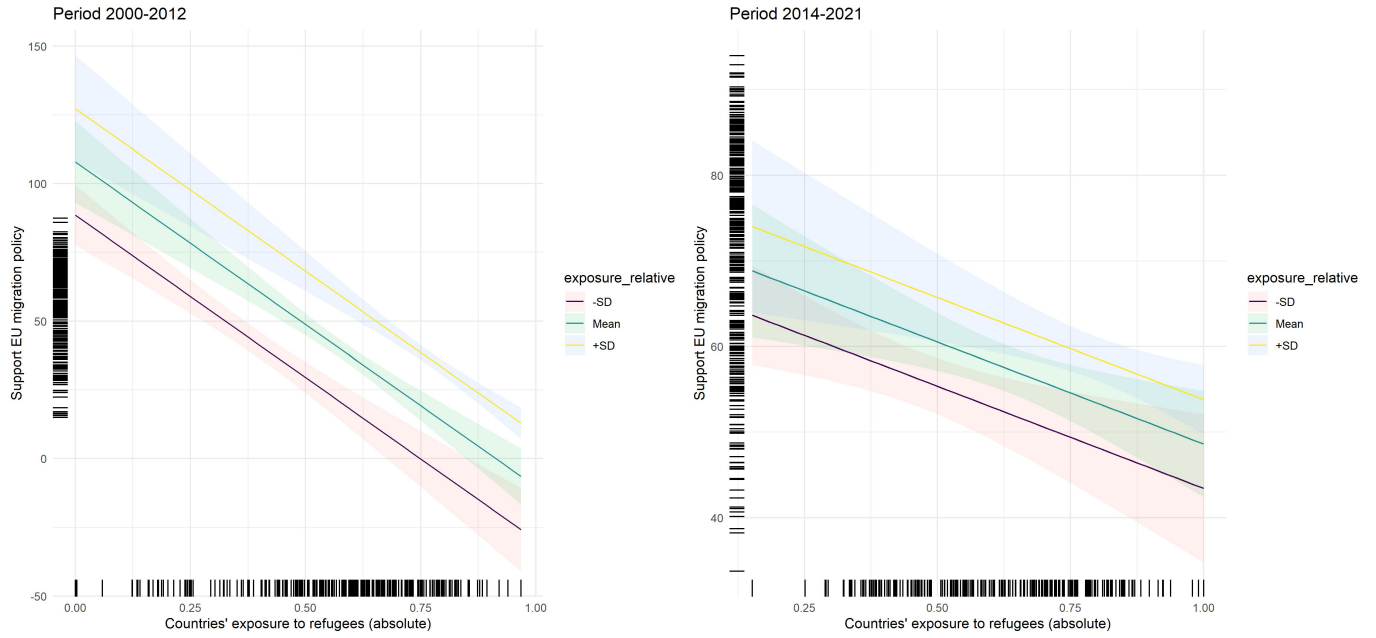
C. Diagnostics and robustness checks

Figure A3: Component-plus-residual plots of panel regression models



Note: Partial residual plots based on panel regression models (1) and (2) from Table 1 in the article.

Figure A4: Predicted probabilities of policy support by number of refugee arrivals



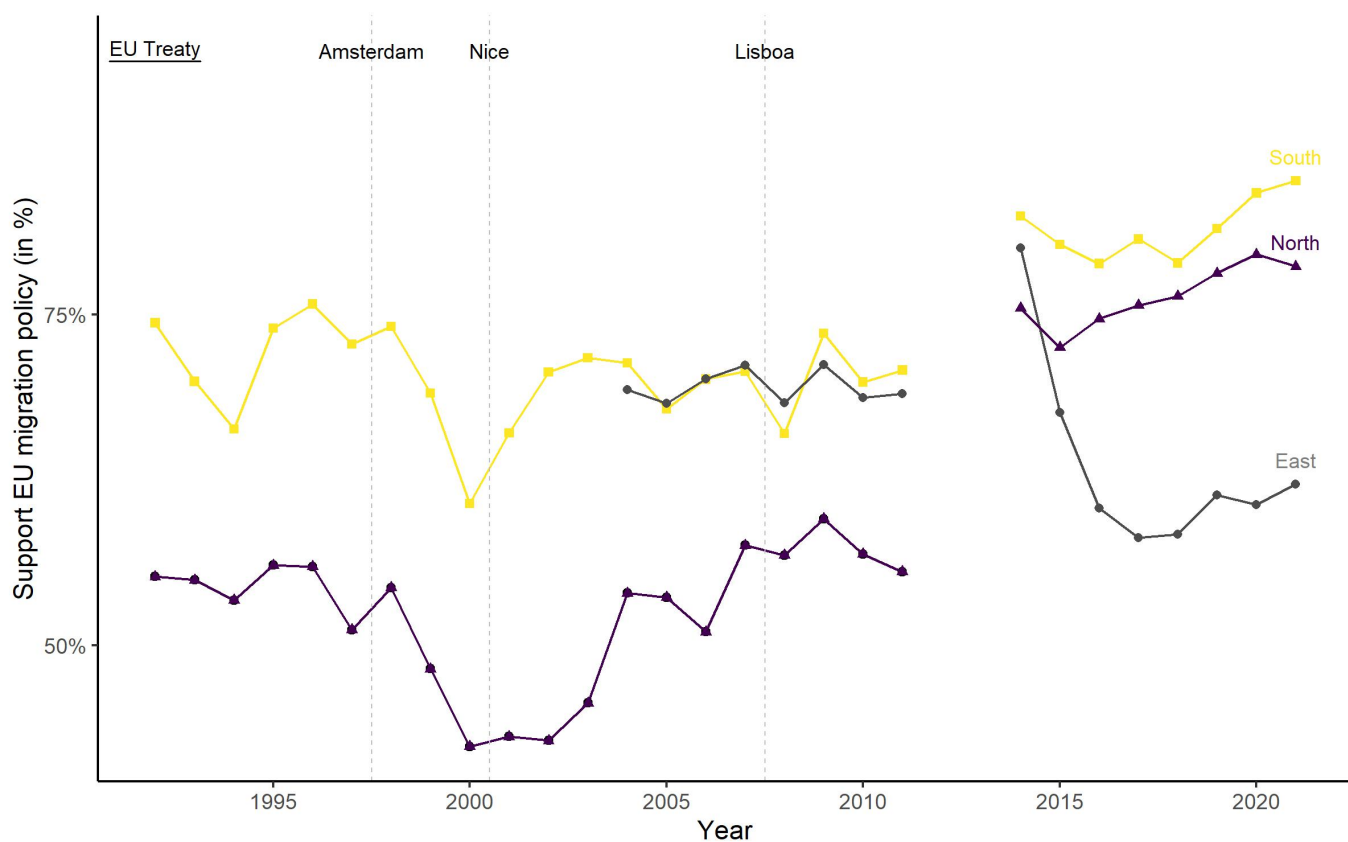
Note: Note: Predicted probabilities (95% confidence interval) based on fixed-effects models (1) & (2) from Table 1 in the article.

Table A4: Alternative panel model specifications

	Support for an EU migration policy			
	Bivariate		Resampling	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
	2000-2012	2014-2021	2000-2012	2014-2021
Refugee arrivals (absolute)	−31.062*** (5.515)	3.764 (2.727)	−111.215*** (16.315)	−36.152*** (10.099)
Refugee arrivals (relative)			104.504*** (16.281)	38.887*** (11.150)
Constant	60.382*** (4.361)	55.767*** (2.344)	35.804*** (5.723)	77.462*** (5.387)
Observations	366	389	220	235
R ²	0.862	0.854	0.919	0.837
Adjusted R ²	0.851	0.843	0.913	0.824

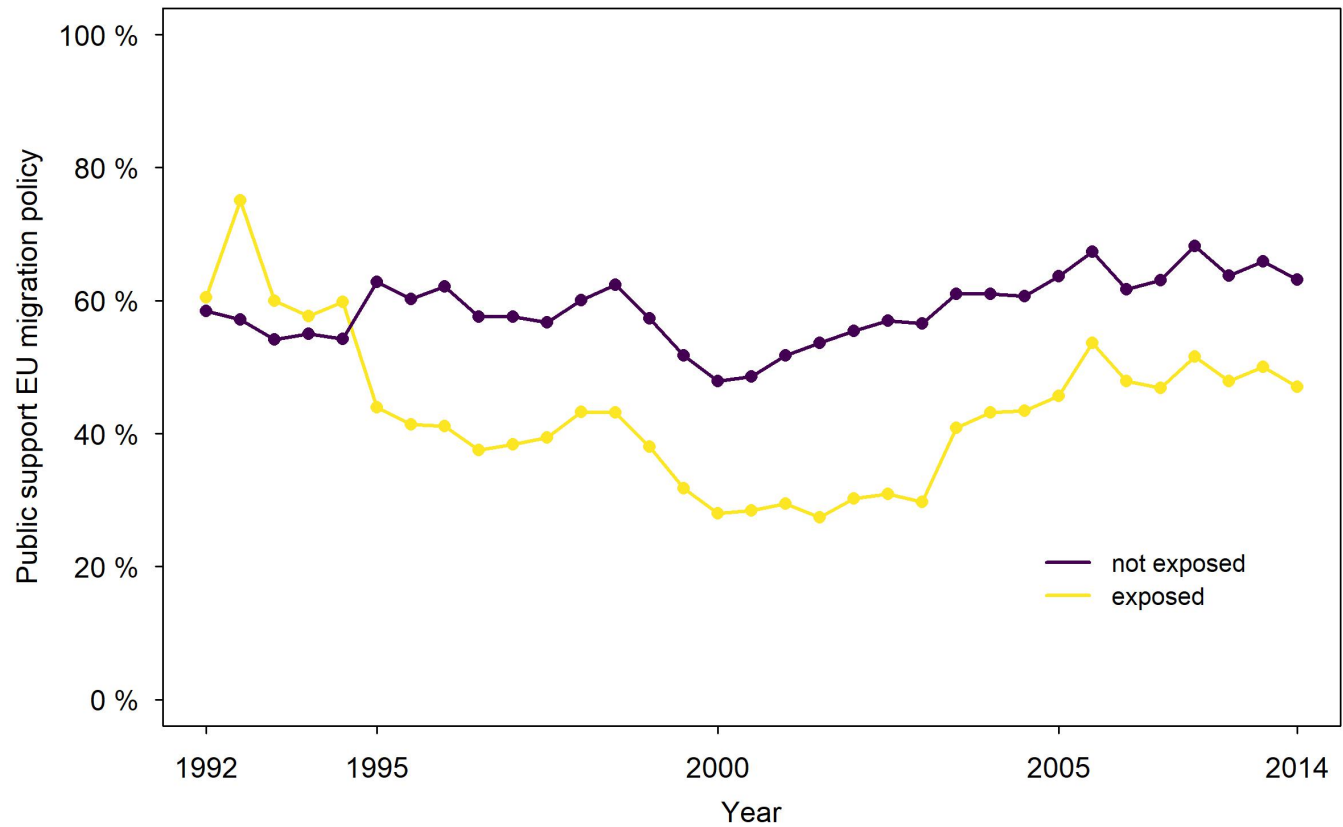
Note: Panel regression models using different model specifications: (1)/(2) Bivariate models only with the absolute number of refugees as IV; (3) & (4) Linear models that exclude countries with a very high correlation between the refugee variables (>0.95). All models with country fixed effects and clustered standard errors. Statistical significance indicated as follows: *p<0.05; **p<0.01; ***p<0.001.

Figure A5: Support for an EU migration policy by country group



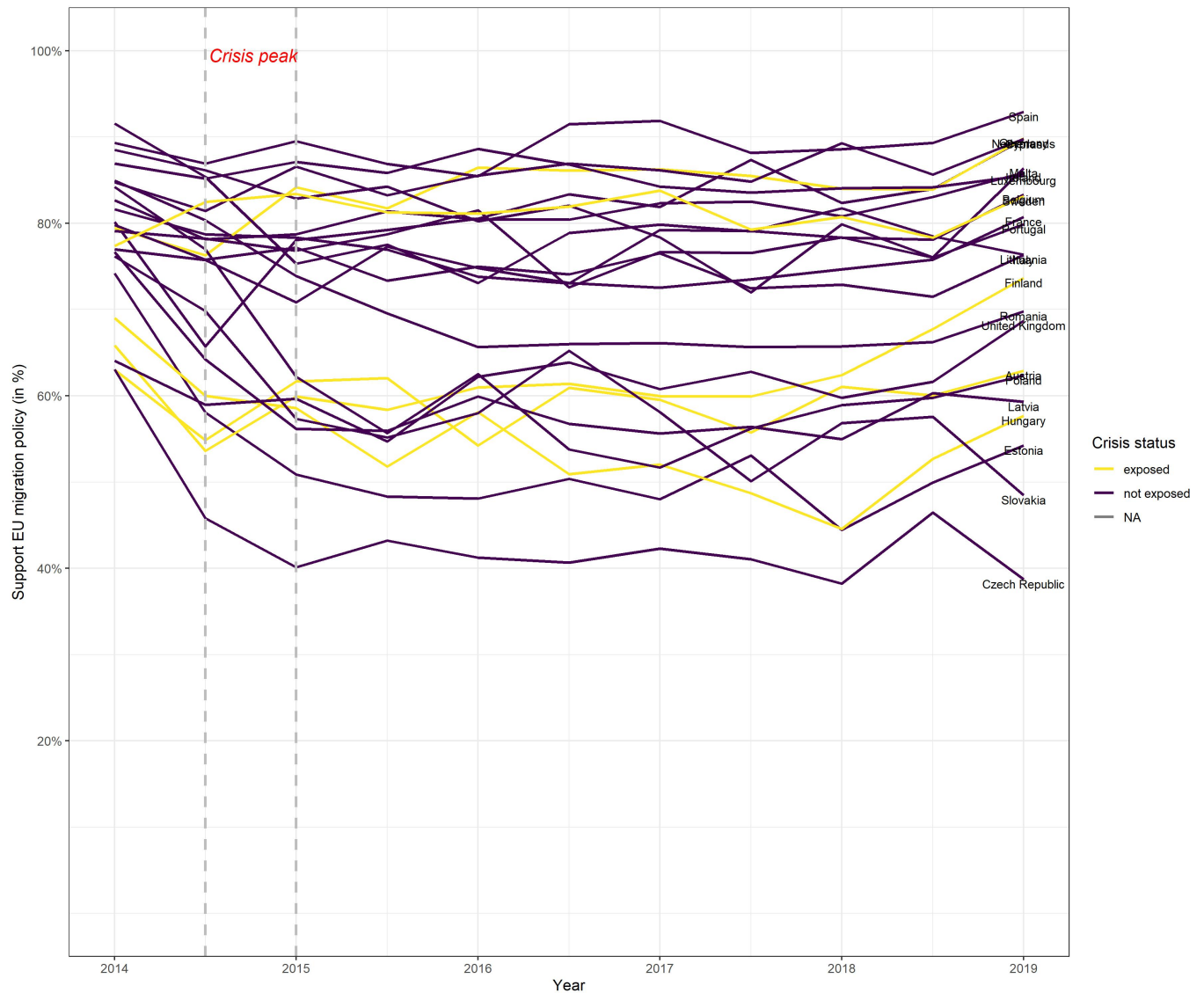
Note: The line plot displays the average support for a common European migration policy across the three groups of EU countries: North (France, Ireland, United Kingdom, Austria, Luxembourg, Belgium, Netherlands, Germany, Denmark, Sweden, Finland), South (Spain, Portugal, Malta, Italy, Greece, Cyprus), East (Czech Republic, Estonia, Latvia, Lithuania, Poland, Slovenia, Slovakia, Croatia, Hungary, Bulgaria, Romania). Population weights employed.

Figure A6: Pre-treatment trend of support for an EU migration policy



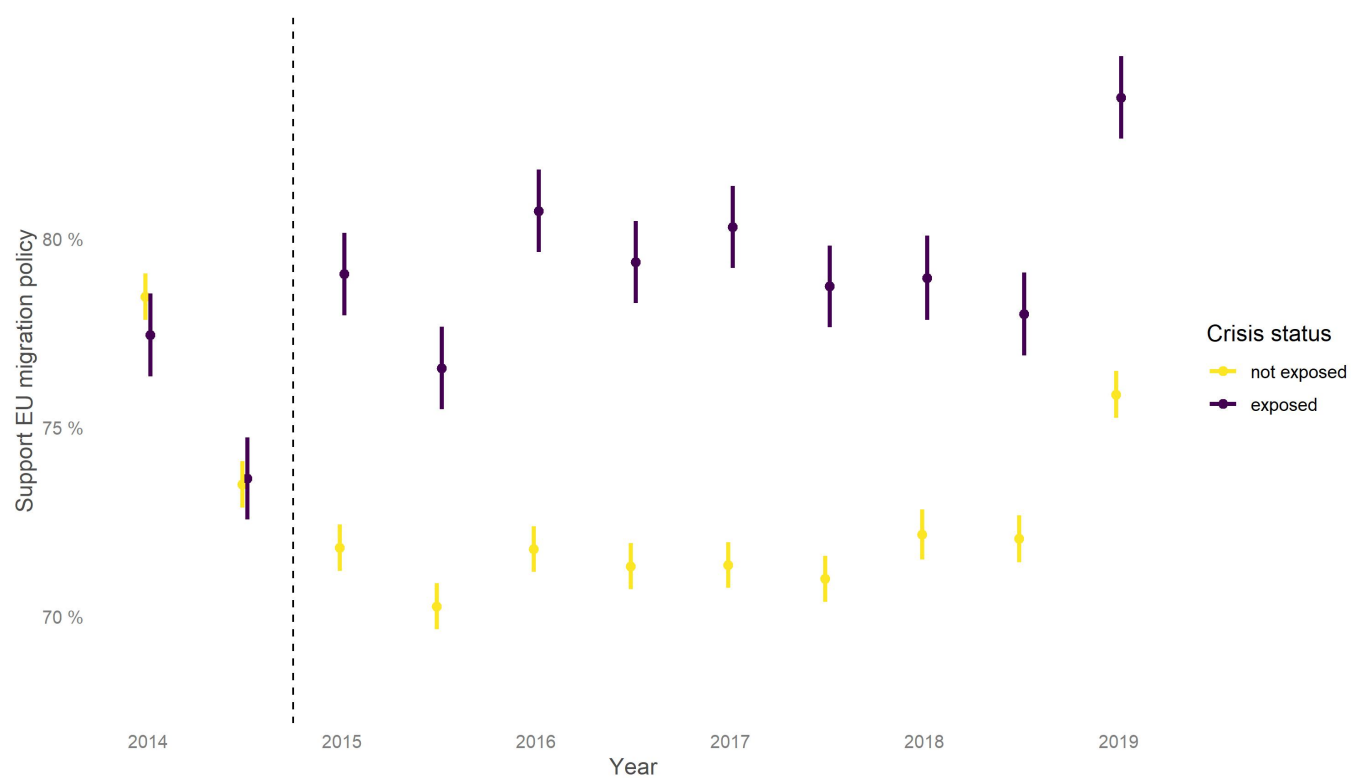
Note: The line plot displays the group means of support for an EU migration policy (in %) for the exposed and the not-exposed countries. The plot excludes transit countries, just as the models do. If they are included, the pattern is almost identical. Data: Eurobarometer.

Figure A7: Country-specific trends in support for an EU migration policy



Note: Line plot of public support for an EU migration policy over time for each EU member state. The vertical dashed lines indicated the peak of the 2015 refugee crisis.

Figure A8: Predicted probabilities of support for EU migration policy



Note: Predicted probabilities based on a difference-in-differences model based on individual-level data and with population weights, designed to be representative of the EU population.

Table A5: DiD estimates with alternative model specifications

	Support EU migration policy				
	(1) West	(2) Transit	(3) Gradual 1	(4) Gradual 2	(5) Controls
<i>DiD estimation:</i>					
Crisis	-1.673 [#] (0.983)	-5.723*** (1.019)	-7.415*** (1.219)	-6.616*** (1.194)	-10.280*** (1.414)
Exposure	18.108 (19.514)	23.136 (18.391)	57.657 (38.296)	27.601 (24.668)	26.119 (19.221)
Crisis*Exposure	2.775 (2.212)	4.894* (2.219)	14.388** (5.319)	5.242 [#] (2.824)	6.608* (3.035)
<i>Control variables:</i>					
EU-attachment					13.755** (4.410)
Unemployment rate					0.945 (0.713)
Share of foreigners					-195.603* (84.910)
Constant	40.232** (14.231)	30.621* (12.715)	26.371* (13.157)	28.351* (12.972)	6.499 (19.782)
Observations	165	308	253	253	207
Countries	15	28	23	23	23
R ²	0.921	0.921	0.931	0.929	0.949
Adjusted R ²	0.903	0.902	0.916	0.913	0.932

Note: Difference-in-difference (DiD) estimates using different model specifications: (1) Sub-sample of 15 West-European member states; (2) Sample that also includes transit countries; (3) & (4) Models with continuous crisis exposure variables; (5) Model including control variables. All models are linear regressions with country-specific time-trends (not shown), and country-clustered standard errors. Statistical significance indicated as follows: [#]p<0.1; *p<0.05; **p<0.01; ***p<0.001.